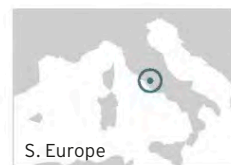


Trevi Fountain

An exuberant Baroque fountain that is one of the most popular tourist sites in Rome



S. Europe

Built of white travertine and marble, the Trevi Fountain is a monumental fountain in the heart of Rome. Its creator was architect Niccolò Salvi (1697–1751), selected for the job after a competition staged by Pope Clement XII in 1732. Salvi produced a flamboyant theatrical design with a basin that is 65 ft (20 m) wide, embellished by huge statues and a high backdrop formed by adding a decorative facade to the palace behind. The sparklingly clear water for the fountain is brought from a spring outside Rome by the Aqua Vergine, a Renaissance update of an original ancient Roman underground aqueduct. Salvi did not live to see the fountain finished, as he died in 1751. His successor, Giuseppe Pannini (1691–1765), completed the project in 1762.

The theme of the fountain's group of statues is "the taming of the waters." The massive figure of Oceanus—one of the ancient immortal Titans, lord of the seas—rides a shell chariot drawn by sea horses and guided by tritons blowing conches. Standing in niches to each side of Oceanus are allegorical statues representing Abundance and Health. The figures of Oceanus and the tritons are by Italian sculptor Pietro Bracci (1700–1773).

The fountain in popular imagination

The romantic potential of the fountain has been exploited in several famous films, most notably William Wyler's *Roman Holiday* (1953) and Federico Fellini's *La Dolce Vita* (1960). Throwing a coin into the basin, to guarantee luck or a return to Rome, is an established tourist custom.

Coins thrown into the fountain each year have added up to over **\$1 million**



△ ALLEGORICAL FIGURES

A triumphal arch on the rear wall frames the statue of Oceanus. To his left is the figure of Abundance, holding the horn of plenty, and to his right is Health, holding a broad cup from which a snake drinks.

◁ MIGHTY OCEANUS

The central figure of Oceanus is 19 ft (5.8 m) high and holds a staff of authority in his right hand. Other sculptural details on the fountain include depictions of more than 30 species of plants.

△ MONUMENTAL GATEWAY

The Brandenburg is Berlin's only surviving historical city gate. Made from sandstone, the Neo-Classical structure is 85 ft (26 m) high, 215 ft (65.5 m) long, and 36 ft (11 m) deep.

